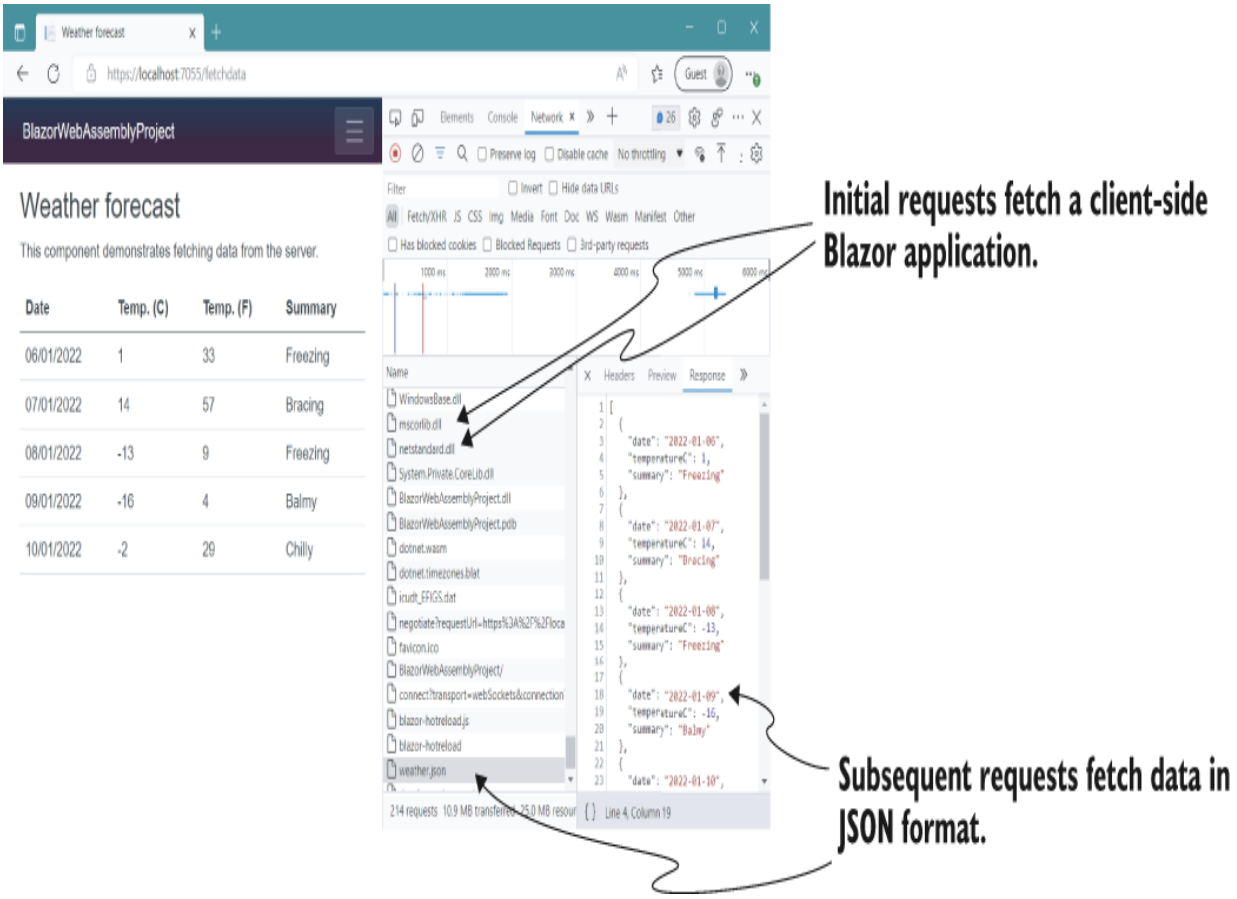


Figure 5.2 A sample client-side SPA using Blazor WebAssembly. The initial requests load the SPA files into the browser, and subsequent requests fetch data from a web API, formatted as JSON.

DEFINITION An *HTTP API* exposes multiple URLs via HTTP that can be used to access or change data on a server. It typically returns data using the JSON format. HTTP APIs are sometimes called web APIs, but as *web API* refers to a specific technology in ASP.NET Core, in this book I use *HTTP API* to refer to the generic concept.

These days, mobile applications are common and, from the server application's point of view, similar to client-side SPAs. A mobile application typically communicates with a server application by using an HTTP API,